

Multi-Industry: 3rd Industrials trip to HVAC InstallerSHOW: Key takeaways

We hosted meetings with five HVAC equipment suppliers and the Director General of the European Heat Pump Association (EHPA) on our field trip to the InstallerSHOW in Birmingham on 24th June 2026. **Our key takeaways are:**

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- 1. Global warming is likely, in our view, to drive further adoption of air-to-air (ATA) heat pumps in the UK and Europe.** This reflects their capability as both a heating and cooling technology, as well as the ambitions of a number of HVAC OEMs that are seeking to broaden their product ranges in response to installers' feedback and their need to achieve economies of scale. We expect innovations in the ATA segment to be a particular focus for the market over the next year, including from NIBE which recently announced its entry into this segment (where it had never had a presence) and Viessmann, which announced the UK launch of its Vitocal 200-A today at the InstallerSHOW.
- 2. The UK heat pump market has significant long-term growth potential, with recent policy changes likely to provide a near-term boost in demand.** Though heat pump (HP) adoption remains low compared to the >1.8m gas boilers sold each year, UK HP sales grew +27% YoY to c.125k units in 2025. With penetration at $\leq 1\%$ of all households there is substantial room for long-term growth, supported by policy measures and consumers' desire to reduce their energy costs. The Government's Warm Homes Plan is targeting c.450,000 annual installations by 2030, with support from subsidy measures such as the Boiler Upgrade Scheme (BUS), which provides grants to consumers replacing existing fossil fuel heating with low-carbon heating systems. The BUS scheme provides £7,500 towards the cost of an air-source heat pump (ASHP) or ground source heat pump (GSHP) installation. Additionally, the scheme recently saw an expansion in scope to include exhaust air heat pumps (a positive for NIBE), while grants of £2,500 will also become available for ATA HPs later this year. From 21st July, homeowners with off-gas grid properties currently heated by oil or LPG will be eligible for a £1,500 uplift for the installation of ASHPs/GSHPs.
- 3. Competition, particularly from Chinese suppliers, remains fierce:** The UK market continues to be dominated by SME installers which largely procure through the trade merchants. This is seen as one of the key competitive moats for the European OEMs. We note, however, that there has been an incremental move towards D2C models in recent years, including via partnerships with utility

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suppliers, such as that between British Gas and NIBE. Broader competitive pressures from Asian manufacturers and other players (such as Octopus Energy and PE-backed OEMs) persist. In the case of the Chinese HVAC OEMs and other new entrants, these players typically seek to differentiate through lower-cost models or direct-to-consumer sales, potentially putting pressure on margins over the long term, in our view. At the same time, OEMs from other parts of Asia (such as Daikin, Mitsubishi, or Samsung) are looking to compete through technology-leadership.

More details and key takeaways by companies below.

European Heat Pump Association

We met with the Director General of the European Heat Pump Association (EHPA), Mr Paul Kenny. Our key takeaways are:

The EHPA expects to see further market consolidation over the coming years. Mr Kenny highlighted that: (1) heat pump OEMs significantly outnumber the companies manufacturing key components. As an example, Mr Kenny noted that there are four main global suppliers for compressors, which comprise some 20-25% of the overall value in a HP, (2) Expanding access to European heating markets remains an ambition of a number of OEMs in Asia and North America, and (3) Economies of scale require annual production volumes of >500k for companies to remain competitive.

Chinese competition remains a growing threat to European producers: In line with point 1 and with trends seen across other industrial end-markets, Asian OEMs continue to seek market share gains across Europe, where the EHPA expect HP volumes to show another year of LDD growth in 2026.

HVAC OEMs are broadening their product ranges in response to installers' feedback and the need to scale. Companies that have historical strengths in a specific product are increasingly looking at expansion into new categories to ensure they can supply their installer customers with options for different consumer needs. Consistent with the market consolidation trend, there is also a drive to increase economies of scale through expansion into ancillary product areas. As an example, NIBE recently announced its entry into the air-to-air HP market, which it had historically shunned. Amidst a week of extraordinarily high temperatures across the UK and Europe, the dual function of air-to-air HPs as a technology for both heating and cooling was a particular focus of discussions at the InstallerSHOW. The UK central heating has traditionally been designed around "wet" circuits and air-to-air heat pumps therefore represented <10% of the systems sold in the UK in 2025. However, Mr. Kenny believes that this could change over time, highlighting that the European air-to-air market is c.6x larger than the air-to-water market. A number of new air-to-air systems were being showcased at the event.

The EHPA continues to champion increased heat pump adoption across Europe, advocating for policies that help to improve the affordability of heat pumps. The association focuses on four key drivers when assessing country-level policies that aim to increase market adoption of the technology: (1) Electricity-to-gas price ratios – an EC policy focus area, where recent changes to energy taxes in Belgium have shown early success in driving behavioural change, (2) Subsidies – while these remain available across Europe, a number of countries' policies have been unclear and/or inconsistent, and have therefore been less effective, (3) Supporting new build construction growth, and (4) Enhancing the competence and competitiveness of the installer market. On this fourth point, and in a follow up to [our past discussion](#) that installation costs in Germany remain high compared to other European countries, Mr. Kenny believed this results from: (a) Higher overall installer margins, (b) Stricter planning rules that require higher technology content, (c) Strict installer qualification requirements for subsidy eligibility, and (d) Subsidies being structured as a percentage of the installed cost, rather than at a fixed value.

NIBE Industrier AB (Sell, 12m TP SEK34)

We met with the Managing Director of NIBE Energy Systems Ltd (NIBE's UK business). Our key takeaways are:

NIBE views the recent extension of the Boiler Upgrade Scheme (BUS) scheme to include Exhaust Air heat pumps as a key positive for its UK business. As one of just three OEM's supplying Exhaust Air HP technology to the UK market, compared to a more competitive air-to-water market, the group believes it is well positioned to benefit from the expansion of funding here. Additionally, the announced step up to £9k from July-26 for those converting from an O&G system is expected to further support demand growth in the UK.

NIBE believes that the BUS is the primary driver of growth in the UK heat pump market today. There were c.125k heat pumps sold in the UK last year. Of the combined £2.7bn in funding for the Boiler Upgrade Scheme, £295m was earmarked for the 2025/26 year. At the standard £7,500 grant for ASHPs/GSHPs, that implies potential support for up to 39,333 heat pump installations. Though the HP market was weak in 1Q following the transition of the low income funding scheme, NIBE expects to see flat volumes in the UK overall for 2026. Some UK demand within ground source HPs is driven by replacement demand, and NIBE notes success in outpacing the market in this product area. Air-to-air has not traditionally been a key market in the UK and NIBE does not currently compete here, estimating that only c.2.5k units are sold annually. While the group recently announced that it would add an air-to-air solution to its offering, we expect its initial focus to be on the French market and do not expect it to see meaningful sales in the UK in the near-term.

Training programs with installers are key for improving customer awareness. NIBE is celebrating its 20th year in the UK market, and has an established installer base, which means that the group has not seen labour shortages impacting its business. Last year the group announced its partnership with GTEC to train installers in the UK. The group believes that the program is going well, with 5k installers now trained to install HPs. Through this arrangement, the group sees scope for further growth in the brand for the years ahead, without the need to directly hire a large cohort of its own field service engineers.

In the last five weeks, NIBE UK has launched a direct-to-customer offering. The group believes that homeowners require access to fast online quoting, and so by launching this offering, it looks to capture more of the D2C market. NIBE UK is also considering setting up a financing option for its customers, similar to those already offered by Energy providers. We believe that this will likely be received well by customers as it breaks down the initial cost barrier to entry that many consumers face, likely broadening its TAM.

Valuation & Key risks

We are Sell rated. Our 12-month price target of SEK34 is based on our sector-relative EV/IC vs. ROIC/WACC methodology on 9m27/3m28E.

Key risks to our Sell thesis: (1) The introduction of more supportive subsidy measures for energy efficient heating systems; (2) Changes to US export regulations/tariffs related

to semiconductor markets; (3) An improvement in European construction markets resulting in better-than-expected sales growth; (4) A reduction in inflation and interest rates; (5) Better-than-expected cost improvements / M&A synergies; (6) Improving supply chains; (7) Cost inflation/pricing; (8) Margin or market share impact from changing trade tariffs (e.g. on imports into the US); and (9) Gas price increases or favourable FX.

Viessmann (subsidiary of Carrier Global, covered by Joe Ritchie)

We met with the sales and product management representatives at Viessmann, a subsidiary of Carrier Global. Our key takeaways are:

Focusing on growth following its multi-year transformation. After a period of portfolio change, the group now has a strong portfolio of intelligent climate and energy solutions for the European HVAC market. Having combined its R&D expertise across the three organisations (Carrier, Toshiba, and Viessmann) the group now aims to bring a high quality, competitively priced offering that is underpinned by compelling warranties and its strong brand heritage across both resi and non-resi markets.

Within the UK market, the group sees a number of opportunities across its three growth vectors: (1) Product – Carrier’s European Datacentre business sees attractive opportunities for growth in the UK, which stands to benefit as the Irish grid has approached capacity constraints. In the resi market, Viessmann targets an expansion into the UK air-to-air HP segment next year, while Toshiba sees opportunities to expand the penetration of its cooling technologies in the UK, (2) Aftermarket – Carrier expects a multi-year aftermarket opportunity to follow the substantial growth in its product sales to the datacentre market, and (3) Systems – In March, Carrier made a strategic investment in *Heat Geek*, a UK-based startup digital sales platform that connects homeowners with Heat Geek-certified, trained local installers who use AI-powered tools to design and install the most efficient heat pump system for each customer’s home. This investment not only illustrates its commitment to the UK market, but highlights the group’s aims to deepen relationships with its installer customers.

Carrier’s UK distribution model provides an edge over Asian peers targeting market entry via D2C. Chinese competition is intensifying in the UK with players looking to buy their way into the heat pump market, which resulted in the recent period of overstocking. However, Viessmann believes most installers buy through trade merchants, who provide their customers with access to credit lines and aftersales support, as well as the ease of a one-stop-shop for all installation requirements including piping and accessories. Viessmann’s UK distribution partners include large wholesalers, three national trade merchants (City Plumbing, UKPS, and Wolseley), and a number of smaller buying groups. Amidst this influx of competition, the group see its distribution model as an advantage vs. Asian suppliers that are predominantly looking to sell D2C.

Viessmann have passed through two +3% price increases this year, in January and in June/July. Because of rising costs, Viessmann’s growth in the UK is expected to reach +6% from pricing alone this year. The group noted that this was slightly less than some other players but broadly in line with the industry.

IMI (Neutral, 12m TP 2,560p)

We met with Marc Robertson, Head of Residential Buildings at IMI's Climate Control business. Our key takeaways are:

IMI continues to pursue an expansion of its share of wallet within a typical residential HVAC system. The group now has a full suite of technologies for both heating and cooling, providing full climate control in the home. Its technologies include pressurisation vessels, valves for system balancing, and thermostatic sensors, as well as the system's control interface. This provides scope for a potential two-fold increase in the c.£1,000 average wallet share currently captured by Heatmiser in a typical UK home (where the average residential HVAC system is comprised of c.6-7 radiators upstairs and an underfloor system at ground level). Its latest R&D initiatives have placed an emphasis on connectivity and the smart home.

IMI's product quality and brand strength drive pull-through demand in an installer-led market. The Heatmiser brand has strong resonance with installers, who drive >90% of the purchase decisions in the residential market. It also has a strong reputation among integrators and specifiers in the newer renewables market, where they are seeing strong pull-through demand for their products. However, IMI's residential climate control offering is now generating c.4-5% of its sales D2C via its website. Where the business is selling via merchants it seeks to incentivise project sales through adaptive pricing.

IMI's >1.5m connected devices and in-house software stack provide direct customer intimacy in an installer-led market, enabling its R&D teams to enhance the user experience and deepen IMI's pull-through demand. The company uses its connected offering to understand end-user behaviour, generated from the c.600,000 users of its app (Heatmiser Neo) which recently underwent a significant upgrade. While the convenience and energy saving advantages of smart controls are clear, having a reliable and easy-to-navigate user interface is key to the user experience. IMI therefore believes having an in-house software team is a key differentiator vs. peers in the segment using third party providers. It believes this provides an advantage in the sale of its smart valves, which generate between 4-6x the value of a manual valve.

Valuation & Key risks

We are Neutral rated: Our 12-month price target of 2,560p is based on an 85% weighting to sector-relative EV/IC to ROIC/WACC, with a 15% weighting to an M&A component (16x EV/EBIT based on precedent transactions), using 12m27E.

Key risks: (1) Better/worse-than-expected IP growth that could positively/negatively impact IA, (2) Potential acceleration/curtailments of customers' capex projects and/or valve maintenance schedules as a result of improving/deteriorating oil prices and/or industrial activity, (3) A positive/negative adjustment in Truck OEMs' production rates, which could drive higher/lower demand for IMI's fluid control products in Transport, (4) The potential sale of the Transport segment, following the Board's strategic review of the business, (5) Better/worse-than-expected residential or commercial construction activity weighing on Climate Control, (6) Cost inflation/disinflation, particularly within the labour component, (7) Risk of margin pressure, share loss, or supply-chain challenges stemming from rising trade tariffs (e.g. on imports into the US), (8) M&A

execution, and, (9) Unfavourable FX.

Stelrad Group plc (not covered)

We met with the Head of Marketing and the broader sales team from Stelrad Group plc. Stelrad is a European manufacturer of central heating radiators, with a product range that spans standard steel panel radiators, through low-temperature solutions for heat pump systems, as well as electric and designer radiators. Our key takeaways are:

The European market leader in radiators: Stelrad manufactures close to fifteen thousand radiators per day and generated c.£280m of revenue last year, supplying customers in over 40 countries. The group has a >50% share of the UK radiator market and a strong presence across Europe as a whole. The company primarily sells steel panel hydronic radiators that are produced in the UK and Turkey. It also supplies electric products under the De'Longhi brand that it acquired in 2022. The group sells 70% of its products through trade merchants, with the remaining 30% sold through other channels, including direct partnerships with installers where they offer a points-based incentive scheme to reward brand loyalty and encourage the up-selling of its products (e.g. to coloured radiators, which are now available in >200 different RAL colours).

Stelrad emphasised three key bottlenecks for HP adoption in the UK. These include: (1) There is a need for new piping and radiator circuits when a conventional boiler system is converted to a heat pump. This can prove costly for customers and, without financial support, customers can be disincentivised from making the transition. (2) ECO funding in the UK was stopped for 6 months following the announcement of the Warm Homes Plan. Without this disruption, Stelrad believe that the market would have performed better. (3) Education and training remain lacking amongst installers. The group believes that installer knowledge of the broader HP installation requirements (such as wider pipes and larger surface area radiators) remains limited, with further training required to support the installer workforce needed for continued market expansion in the replacement market.

The group has not seen supply chain issues or disruptions from the availability of raw materials. As the group holds 6 weeks worth of Steel, it has not seen supply chain disruptions so far, as a result of the conflict in the Middle East.

Stelrad provides an electric radiator offering from its DeLonghi acquisition. In 2022, Stelrad purchased DeLonghi's technology for radiator applications, as well as the ability to use the DeLonghi and DL brands. This has helped the group to expand its presence in markets with a greater share of electric heating systems, such as France.

Luceco (not covered)

We met with the Marketing and Sales Directors from Luceco's Sync Energy brand. Luceco is a £420m market cap UK manufacturer that generated £271m of revenues last year. It designs, supplies, and manufactures a range of wiring accessories, LED lighting, and portable power solutions. The group's portable power segment generated c.£61m of revenue in FY25 (23% of group). Sync Energy operates within this segment, providing EV charging solutions and energy storage for residential and commercial applications.

Our key takeaways are:

Regulation is driving growth in the residential EV charging market. The group estimates that it holds a 10–12% market share of the c.£500m UK EV charging market currently, and expects the market will continue to grow given every UK new build now requires EV charging port installation. Through its wiring accessories and circuit protection products, broader Luceco brands are already specified into some 50,000 new homes per year and the group has strong relationships with wholesalers and housebuilders. The group's non-residential EV charging sales grew +80% last year to £30m and it targets a further +75–80% growth in the coming year, thereby expecting to outperform the market at +20%.

As solar panel adoption continues to grow in the UK, residential battery storage offers attractive growth potential. With a £4–6k cost for the group's stackable battery, this product offers a financially accessible solution to reduce consumer energy bills, per management. Through Sync Energy's recently rolled out app, the Flexi battery charging option allows customers to sell reduced-fare electricity back to the grid at peak prices based on individual demand trends. When used in conjunction with solar panels, the battery storage option has the potential to halve the payback period of a PEV installation. As a standalone battery system its payback period would be 4–6 years, compared to a 10-year warranty period, and estimated 15 year useful life. In addition to targeting private market customers, the group is working with social housing developers, such as Willmott Dixon.

Simplicity, reliability, and connectivity have been key to Sync Energy's success.

Echoing the culture of its broader Luceco group, the Sync Energy brand aims to supply customers with a well-designed, reliable, and well-made product. Per management, the functionality of the product is then further complemented by its in-house software, and an easy-to-use app which creates a tailored user experience to help customers better manage their energy costs.

The group highlights that its strong relationships with merchants and installers are key for competing within the EV charging and battery storage markets. Access to a network of installers enables Luceco to carry out its warranty-based work. In addition to its direct-to-wholesaler approach, Sync Energy benefits from being a part of a larger group with access to a broader set of resources and expertise. It believes that this is more of a challenge for some smaller middle market competitors. The group produces its battery products in Jiaying, China, enabling low manufacturing costs with control over its supply chain and capacity. The group sources its cells from an external supplier, but assembles the pack in-house in order to maximise quality control. With many mid-market battery storage competitors struggling with capacity, Sync Energy believes

this has been a significant driver of the growth acceleration that the group has seen recently.

Disclosure Appendix

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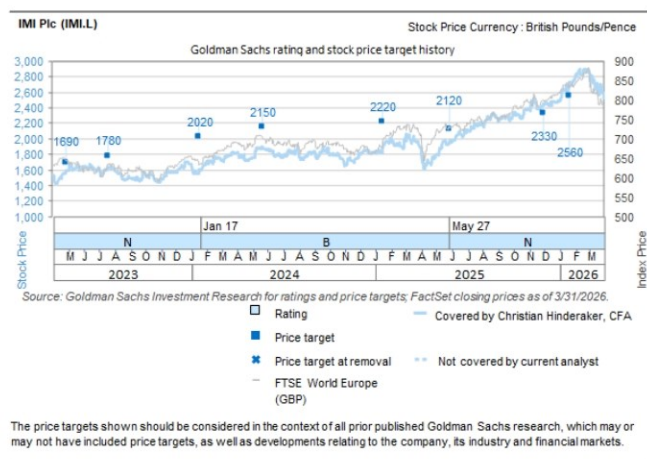
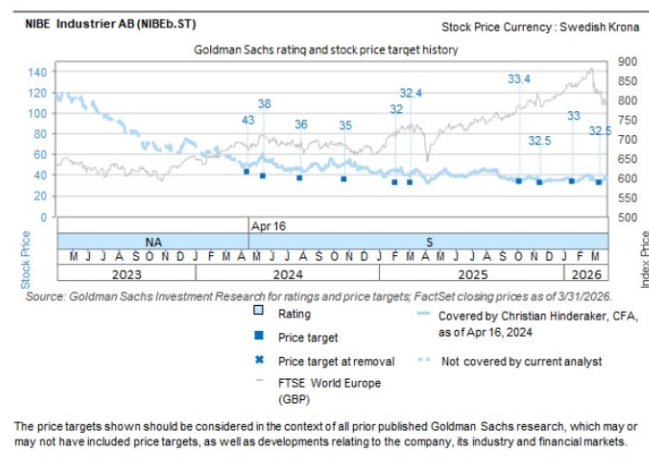
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)

NIBE Industrier AB (NIBEb.ST)

Date of report	Target price (Skr)	Closing price (Skr)
19-May-26	34.00	39.98
16-Mar-26	32.50	33.98
21-Jan-26	33.00	35.40
17-Nov-25	32.50	32.86
07-Oct-25	33.40	36.38
05-Mar-25	32.40	41.24
03-Feb-25	32.00	43.50
25-Oct-24	35.00	51.78
30-Jul-24	36.00	46.97
17-May-24	38.00	53.96
16-Apr-24	43.00	49.54

IMI Plc (IMIL.L)

Date of report	Target price (£)	Closing price (£)
21-Jan-26	2,560	2,672
01-Dec-25	2,330	2,450
27-May-25	2,120	1,948
16-Jan-25	2,220	1,877
21-May-24	2,150	1,900
17-Jan-24	2,020	1,608
20-Jul-23	1,780	1,625

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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